

Existentialism — Complete Offline Revision Guide

Philosophy Optional · Paper I · Western Philosophy · Topic 10

Philosophy Optional · Paper I · Western Philosophy · Topic 10

Substantive source cells were reconciled, adapted and mapped; repeated apparatus was consolidated. Source-cell retention is checked mechanically and does not prove semantic completeness, philosophical truth or an examiner score.

CONTENTS

Page numbers are generated from the final layout. PDF bookmarks include finer subheadings.

Study sequence	3	6. KEYWORD & STATEMENT BANK ⚠	25
0. ONE-SCREEN MAP ⚠	3	RESTORED 2018/2020 DOCTRINE DOSSIER	26
0A. PRINTED THINKERS, SOURCE MAP AND OWNER SCOPE	4	7. PYQ ROUTING (2018–2025)	27
1. EXISTENCE AND ESSENCE ✓	5	8. ANSWER ARCHITECTURE ⚠	29
2. CHOICE, RESPONSIBILITY AND AUTHENTIC EXISTENCE ✓	7	9. INTER-TINKER DEBATES ⚠	34
2A. BOUNDED CORE: THE LOOK (le regard) AND BEING-FOR-OTHERS (l'être-pour-autrui) ✓	15	D. DIRECTIVE DECODER ⚠ — what each command word obliges you to do here	35
2B. KIERKEGAARD — INDIRECT COMMUNICATION AND PSEUDONYMITY ✓	17	V. GRADED VERDICT BANK ⚠ — executable closing positions	36
3. BEING-IN-THE-WORLD AND TEMPORALITY ✓	19	T. TRANSLATION, QUOTATION & PROVENANCE DISCIPLINE ✓	37
4. CRITICISMS AND REPLIES ⚠	22	10. LINK-OUTS	39
4A. MARKS-ESSENTIAL OWNER CONTENT AND OPTIONAL ENRICHMENT	24	SOURCES	40
5. COMMON UPSC TRAPS ⚠	24	11. RAPID REVISION AND CLOSED-BOOK RECALL	40
		12. FINAL CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES	41

Study sequence

1. Reconstruct the family map without notes.
2. Study Kierkegaard, Heidegger and Sartre as distinct projects.
3. Practise the Husserl/Heidegger and Husserl/Sartre boundaries explicitly.
4. Attempt the coverage-sized MCQ bank closed-book.
5. Write one timed answer, then repair it against the demand audit.

Current-affairs boundary: no direct verified current-affairs event is established for this static syllabus topic. Contemporary examples are analytical illustrations only.

Syllabus (verbatim): Existentialism (Kierkegaard, Sarte, Heidegger): Existence and Essence; Choice, Responsibility and Authentic Existence; Being-in-the-world and Temporality. **Evidence key:** ✓ canonical doctrine · ⚠ analytical synthesis (mine, for exam use) · ? contested/uncertain **Placement:** A joint-highest Western owner with 16 primary-owned parts across 2018–2026. This is a retrospective family of distinct projects, not one doctrine: **Kierkegaard** is theistic and anti-systematic, **Sartre** atheistic and freedom-centred, and **Heidegger** ontological and anti-humanist. Restored questions add bad faith/alienation, the single individual, facticity and Heidegger's critique of transcendental reduction.

0. ONE-SCREEN MAP ⚠

THREE DISTINCT PROJECTS – A FAMILY RESEMBLANCE, NOT ONE CREED:
concrete existence, finitude and situated choice resist abstract closure

CONCRETE EXISTENCE · CHOICE · FINITUDE		
KIERKEGAARD (theistic)	SARTRE (atheistic)	HEIDEGGER (ontological)
• den Enkelte (the individual) • truth = subjectivity • 3 stages: aesthetic → ethical → religious • leap of faith	• pour-soi / en-soi • radical freedom • "condemned to be free" • bad faith • anguish, abandon- ment, despair • choice legislates for all humanity	• Dasein • In-der-Welt-sein • ready-to-hand / present-at-hand • Care (Sorge) • Being-toward-death • Temporality (3 ecstases) • das Man (the "they") • authenticity ≠ moral

- vs Hegel's system
- no God, no excuses
- virtue

🔑 **Mnemonic — "K-S-H = Faith / Freedom / Finitude":** Kierkegaard = leap of **Faith**; Sartre = radical **Freedom**; Heidegger = **Finitude** (being-toward-death). Three thinkers, three F's.

WHO SAYS WHAT — Quick-Reference Table ⚠️

Concept	Kierkegaard	Sartre	Heidegger
Core term for human being	The single individual (<i>den Enkelte</i>)	The for-itself (<i>pour-soi</i>)	Dasein (the entity for whom Being is at issue)
"Existence precedes essence"	Not his formula: the existing individual resists systematic closure	Explicit: the founding slogan of atheistic existentialism	Rejected as <i>humanistic</i> misreading; but "the essence of Dasein lies in its existence"
Route/authenticity	Religious faith in pseudonymous/signed contexts	Bad-faith critique; positive authenticity remains underdeveloped	Anticipatory resoluteness toward death, not a moral programme
God	Central to religious existence	Atheism is a premise of Sartre's 1946 argument	Not decided by the fundamental ontology of <i>Being and Time</i>
Chief enemy	Hegel's objective spirit; the "crowd"	Determinism; bad faith; the serious spirit	Cartesian subject-object dualism; <i>das Man</i>
Key mood	Anxiety/dread (<i>Angest</i>), despair	Anguish (<i>angoisse</i>), nausea	Anxiety (<i>Angst</i>)
Freedom	Qualitative choice within finite God-relation	Radical but situated and factual	Thrown projection of possibilities, not voluntarism

0A. PRINTED THINKERS, SOURCE MAP AND OWNER SCOPE

- 📄 The official syllabus prints "**Sarte**"; the intended thinker is **Jean-Paul Sartre**. Preserve the typo only when quoting the syllabus.
- The printed thinkers are **Kierkegaard, Sartre and Heidegger**. Nietzsche, Marcel, Jaspers, Camus and de Beauvoir are not independent owner-thinkers here and may appear only as bounded comparison/criticism.

Thinker/source	Marks-essential ownership
Kierkegaard's pseudonymous and signed works	single individual, subjective appropriation, spheres, anxiety/despair, faith and anti-system critique
Heidegger, <i>Being and Time</i> (1927)	Dasein, Being-question, being-in-the-world, care, authenticity and temporality
Heidegger, "Letter on Humanism" (1947)	rejection of Sartrean humanism and slogan ownership

Thinker/source	Marks-essential ownership
Sartre, <i>Being and Nothingness</i> (1943)	in-itself/for-itself, nothingness, facticity/transcendence, bad faith, freedom and the Look
Sartre, <i>Existentialism Is a Humanism</i> (1946)	existence-precedes-essence, anguish/abandonment/despair and universal responsibility

- "Existentialism" is a retrospective family-label, not a unified school. Kierkegaard's religious existence, Heidegger's phenomenological fundamental ontology and Sartre's atheistic humanism differ in aim, method and vocabulary.
- Sartre's slogan must not be attributed to Kierkegaard or Heidegger. Heidegger explicitly resists the humanist reversal of essence/existence.
- Full Nietzschean nihilism, will to power, recurrence and overhuman doctrine are outside this printed owner.
- Camusian absurdity, Jaspers's boundary situations, Marcel's mystery and de Beauvoir's ethics of ambiguity are optional comparisons only.
- Husserlian reduction and Hegelian system appear as indispensable contrasts; their positive systems remain with their owners.

1. EXISTENCE AND ESSENCE

1.1 Sartre: "Existence Precedes Essence" (PYQ 2024 — 10+10m)

The slogan and its exact meaning: - For a manufactured object (Sartre's *paper-knife / coupe-papier*), the artisan first conceives its design (essence/function) and *then* produces it (existence). Essence precedes existence. - Traditional philosophy (and theism) treated *man* analogously: God conceives "human nature" and then creates individuals to that blueprint. - **Sartre denies this:** there is no God (atheism is a *premise*, not a conclusion, of Sartre's existentialism). Therefore there is no prior design. "*Man first of all exists, encounters himself, surges up in the world — and defines himself afterwards.*"  - **Consequence for the for-itself (*pour-soi*):** no predetermined blueprint exhausts human reality. Biology, history and society form facticity and constraint, but they do not by themselves settle the meaning/project one takes up. "Man is nothing else but what he makes of himself" belongs to Sartre's 1946 lecture and must be balanced by situation.  - **Why it entails atheism for Sartre's version:** if God existed, essence *would* precede existence (God would be the divine artisan); so the slogan is incompatible with theism. (Note: this is *Sartre's* reading. Kierkegaard is an existentialist *and* a theist — so the slogan in its Sartrean form is not definitional of all existentialism.) 

1.2 Heidegger's Rejection of the Slogan

- In the "Letter on Humanism" (1947), Heidegger explicitly **disowns** Sartre's reading:
- "*The essence of Dasein lies in its existence*" (*Being and Time* §9) does NOT mean "existence precedes essence" in Sartre's voluntarist sense. 
- For Heidegger, this is an **ontological** claim: Dasein's "what" (essence) is not a fixed *quidditas* but its very *manner of being* — its being-open-to-Being, its *Existenz* (standing-out into the clearing of Being).

- Sartre, Heidegger charges, remains trapped in the **metaphysics of subjectivity** — he merely reverses the essence/existence priority while keeping the humanistic framework (man at the centre). Heidegger insists that the question is not about *man's self-creation* but about **Being** (*Sein*) — man is the "shepherd of Being," not the lord of beings. ⚠️
- **Exam implication:** never attribute "existence precedes essence" to Heidegger without immediately noting his repudiation. The examiner tests this distinction (see TRAPS §5). ⚠️

1.3 Kierkegaard: The Existing Individual Against the System (PYQ 2023, 2024) ✓

- Kierkegaard's target: **Hegel's System** — the claim that reality is the self-development of Absolute Spirit (*Geist*), that the individual is a moment in a total rational process, and that "the truth is the whole."
- Kierkegaard's counter: "the System" explains everything *except* the existing individual who is supposed to understand it. To exist is to be *particular, temporal, passionate, deciding* — none of which can be captured by Hegel's abstract categories. ✓
- **"Truth is subjectivity"** is argued by the pseudonym **Johannes Climacus** in the *Concluding Unscientific Postscript* (1846):
- This does NOT mean "anything I believe is true" (that would be relativism — a common misreading and UPSC trap).
- It means: the *mode of appropriation* matters more than the objective content when we are dealing with existential/ethical/religious truth. *How* one holds a belief (with infinite passionate inwardness, personal commitment, risk) is the locus of truth for the *existing* subject. ✓
- It concerns ethical/religious existence and appropriation, not a general theory that factual truth varies with passion.
- Example: to "know" that God exists as an item in a philosophical system is NOT the same as *existing before God* in faith, trembling, and passionate commitment.
- **"Subjectivity is untruth"** (the dialectical complement): the existing subject is also *in untruth* (sin, finitude, non-identity with the eternal) and needs the "leap" to overcome this. ⚠️

1.4 Kierkegaard's Three Stages / Spheres of Existence (PYQ 2022 — 20m, PYQ 2023 — 10m) ✓

Stage	Core	Mode	Limit / Despair
Aesthetic	Living for the moment—the interesting, enjoyment and avoidance of binding commitment	Immediacy, detachment, irony (pseudonymous portrayals in <i>Either/Or</i>)	Boredom, fragmentation and despair
Ethical	Living by universal duty — commitment, marriage, vocation, transparency	The "judge" (Judge Wilhelm in <i>Either/Or</i>); the self as responsible agent choosing under universal categories	Guilt — the ethical demands are impossible to fulfil perfectly; the universal cannot accommodate the individual's anguished singularity
Religious	Standing before God as a singular individual — faith as "the absurd," infinite passion	Abraham in <i>Fear and Trembling</i> ; the knight of faith; "infinite resignation" + the double movement of faith	The paradox — faith is not rational, not universal, not mediated by the crowd or the church

- **Movement between spheres:** not a compulsory psychological chronology and not Hegelian deduction. Transition requires qualitative choice/leap, but “leap of faith” is a standard summary rather than one formula to quote without source caution. ✓
- **Teleological suspension of the ethical:** the pseudonym **Johannes de Silentio** analyses Abraham in *Fear and Trembling*. The text stages the paradox of faith; it should not be cited as Kierkegaard's straightforward licence for private revelation to override morality. ✓
- **Against Hegel:** Kierkegaard insists that existing, choosing individuality cannot be completed as one moment viewed from an impersonal finished system. This is a critique of systematic closure, not proof that Hegel simply erases every individual. ✓ (PYQ 2023 Q1(d)—direct demand.)

1.5 Kierkegaard on anxiety and despair

- **Anxiety/dread (*Angest*),** presented by the pseudonym Vigilius Haufniensis, is the “dizziness of freedom”: possibility discloses that one can choose and fail. It is not merely fear with greater intensity.
- **Despair,** analysed by Anti-Climacus in *The Sickness unto Death*, is a misrelation in the self's relation to itself and to the power that established it. Forms include not willing to be oneself and defiantly willing to be oneself without the grounding God-relation.
- These are pseudonymous analyses with distinct voices. Do not combine Kierkegaardian despair with Sartre's “despair” in the 1946 lecture, where the term concerns acting without relying on outcomes beyond one's control.

2. CHOICE, RESPONSIBILITY AND AUTHENTIC EXISTENCE ✓

2.1 Sartre: Radical Freedom ✓

- **Freedom is not a property we possess; it is what we ARE.** The *pour-soi* is *constituted* by freedom — it is the nihilating, self-transcending movement of consciousness that continually surpasses what it is toward what it is not yet. ✓
- **“Man is condemned to be free”** (*Existentialism Is a Humanism*, 1946): we did not choose existence, yet cannot escape taking up a stance within situations. “Thrown” is Heidegger's term and should not be silently made Sartre's own. Responsibility is radical but must be analysed with facticity and constraint. ✓
- **“I can always choose, but I ought to know that if I do not choose, I am still choosing”** (PYQ 2021 — 15m): inaction, deferral, conformity are themselves *choices* — the attempt to escape choice is already a choice (and typically a choice of bad faith). ✓

2.2 Anguish, Abandonment, Despair ✓

Mood	Source	Structure
Anguish (<i>angoisse</i>)	I recognise that I am <i>free</i> — my future is radically undetermined; nothing compels me; I stand before the abyss of possibility	Anguish is not fear <i>of</i> an object but vertigo before one's own freedom: “I am not sustained by anything, nothing justifies me”

Mood	Source	Structure
Abandonment (<i>délaissement</i>)	There is no God, no cosmic moral order, no <i>a priori</i> values written in an "intelligible heaven"	I must <i>invent</i> values through my choosing; I cannot lean on a pre-given ethical framework
Despair (<i>désespoir</i>)	I should not rely on outcomes beyond my action and reasonable probabilities	Sartre's lecture-term differs from Kierkegaard's theological account of despair

2.3 Bad Faith (*Mauvaise Foi*) (PYQ 2023 — implicit in "consciousness is what it is not...") ✓

Definition: bad faith is a form of **self-deception** in which the *pour-soi* flees from its freedom by pretending to be a fixed *thing* (en-soi) — or, conversely, flees from its facticity by pretending to be pure transcendence.

The exact structure — facticity and transcendence: - Every human reality has two dimensions: - **Facticity** — the given: my body, my past, my social position, my situation. - **Transcendence** — the self-surpassing: my freedom to *negate* my facticity, to project myself beyond what I presently am. - **Bad faith** occurs when I identify exclusively with *one* dimension at the expense of the other. ✓

Sartre's examples: | Example | What happens | Structure of bad faith | |---|---|---| | **The waiter** | He performs the role with exaggerated, thing-like precision | Sartre reads this as denial that a social role exhausts the for-itself; role-performance alone is not automatically bad faith | | **The woman on the date** | A man takes her hand; she leaves it there, "not noticing" — she treats the hand as a mere physical thing, dissociating from the situation's meaning | She denies her *transcendence* (her freedom to accept or reject the advance) by reducing herself to pure *facticity* (a body-object); simultaneously she denies the *facticity* of the gesture (its sexual meaning) by treating it as purely neutral. A double lie. ✓ |

Why bad faith is paradoxical: to deceive myself, I must simultaneously *know* the truth (to conceal it) and *not know* it (to be deceived). Sartre's solution: consciousness is *non-self-identical* (the *pour-soi* "is what it is not and is not what it is") — it can hold truth and denial in a single pre-reflective stance without splitting into two persons (deceiver and deceived). ⚠

2.4 The for-itself / in-itself distinction (*pour-soi / en-soi*) (PYQ 2025 — 10m; PYQ 2023 — 15m) ✓

	En-soi (Being-in-itself)	Pour-soi (Being-for-itself)
Nature	Full, solid, self-identical, opaque	Nihilating, self-surpassing, never self-identical
Formula	"It is what it is"	"It is what it is not and is not what it is"
Examples	A stone, a table — they simply <i>are</i>	Consciousness — it is always <i>beyond</i> itself, intending what it is not, negating what it is
Freedom	None — determined, complete	Structurally inescapable yet situated/factual
Temporality	Not defined by projective temporal transcendence	Ecstatic—related to past facticity and future project

	En-soi (Being-in-itself)	Pour-soi (Being-for-itself)
Relationship	Groundless, brute ("de trop" — in excess, contingent)	Desires to <i>become</i> en-soi (to achieve full self-identity) — but this is impossible; to be a "pour-soi-en-soi" (= God) is a contradiction ✓

"**Consciousness is what it is not and is not what it is**" (PYQ 2023 Q3(c) — 15m): - "**Is what it is not**": consciousness is always *ahead of itself*, projecting toward possibilities it does not yet possess. It *is* (in the sense of being-defined-by) its future — which does not yet exist. - "**Is not what it is**": consciousness can never coincide with its past or its facticity. The waiter *is* a waiter (facticity) but simultaneously *is not* a waiter (he transcends the role, is free to quit). ✓ - This **non-self-identity** is possible through **nihilation** (*néantisation*): consciousness introduces *nothingness* (*néant*) into being — it stands back from what is and negates it (questions it, imagines alternatives, projects beyond it). The pour-soi is "the being by which nothingness comes into the world." ✓

2.4A CONSCIOUSNESS AS "NOTHING" — SARTRE MEASURED AGAINST HUSSERL ✓

(owner block; 2026 Q2(c), 15 marks)

Ownership note: Sartre's doctrine and the comparison are owned here. Husserl's own method — epoché, reductions, the transcendental ego, intersubjectivity — is owned by PhenomenoLogic-Husserl.md §§1.2–1.5 and 3A, which cross-links back to this block.

2.4A.1 The shared phenomenological floor ✓ (state this first, or the contrast is unearned)

1. **Intentionality.** Sartre takes over Husserl's thesis that consciousness is always **consciousness of something** and is directed beyond itself; the intentional object is not an inner picture standing between us and the world. ✓
2. **Anti-representationalism.** Both refuse the "stomach of consciousness" model in which ideas are contents digested inside the mind.
3. **Pre-reflective self-awareness.** Both accept that consciousness is tacitly aware of itself without first turning itself into an object. ✓
4. **Method.** Both describe *how* things are given rather than inferring hidden causes.

2.4A.2 Sartre's radicalisation — six steps ✓

1. **No contents.** If intentionality is taken seriously, consciousness has **no thing-like interior**: it is "a great emptiness, a wind blowing toward objects."
2. **No inhabitant.** The Ego is **not** a transcendental subject *inside* consciousness; it is a **transcendent object constituted in reflection** (*The Transcendence of the Ego*, 1936–37) — the "I" is met in the world alongside other objects.
3. **Pre-reflective cogito.** Consciousness is **non-positionally** aware of itself while **positionally** directed at the world; reflection is a later, second-order act that produces the Ego.
4. **Why "nothing."** Consciousness is *néant* not because it does not exist, but because it **lacks the self-identity and plenitude of being-in-itself**: it has no essence, no nature, no given content to coincide with.

5. **Nihilation.** As **for-itself**, it introduces negation into being: it withdraws from the given, questions it, projects possibilities — "it is what it is not and is not what it is."
 6. **Freedom.** Nothingness is the ontological ground of freedom: because no factual state is fused with consciousness, no state can mechanically fix how consciousness interprets or surpasses it. ✓
- ✓ **The Pierre-in-the-café argument:** expecting Pierre, I find the café organised around his **absence**; the whole room "nihilates" itself as ground for a figure that is missing. Negation is therefore not merely a linguistic judgement added afterwards — it **structures the experienced field**, which is Sartre's evidence that nothingness is phenomenologically real.

2.4A.3 Contrast with Husserl ⚠

Axis	Husserl	Sartre
Status of the ego	transcendental reduction discloses constituting subjectivity ; the pure ego has habitualities and sedimented history	the ego is a transcendent object of reflection ; consciousness is non-egological
What unifies experience	the ego, together with inner time-consciousness, unifies streams and object-identities	the object and the intentional structure unify consciousness; no inner unifier is needed
Core task	constitution of meaning/noematic sense for a transcendental subjectivity	disclosure of transcendent being and of the contingency ("de trop") of what is
Metaphysical tendency	a transcendental-idealist strand after the <i>Ideas</i>	initially a phenomenological realism : being-in-itself is not constituted by consciousness
Place of negation	negation analysed within intentional acts, judgement and fulfilment/frustration	nothingness becomes the ontological structure of the for-itself
Result for the self	an ego that can be studied in its constituting life	selfhood as a task/project , never a substance; bad faith becomes possible
Freedom	not the organising problem of the method	the direct consequence of consciousness's lack of being

2.4A.4 Sartre's objections to the transcendental ego, numbered ✓

1. **Superfluity:** a transcendental ego duplicates consciousness with an unnecessary inner observer; intentionality already unifies experience through its objects.
2. **Opacity:** an ego *in* consciousness would introduce something non-transparent into what is, by its nature, translucent to itself.
3. **Priority:** a constituting ego would have to pre-exist its acts — which conflicts with the primacy of the spontaneous field (and, later, with "existence precedes essence").
4. **Reification:** it turns a spontaneous transcendental field into a substance-like thing, and thereby reopens the very substantialism phenomenology set out to bracket.

2.4A.5 Replies and the required qualification ? (the mark-winning paragraph)

- **Husserlian reply:** the pure ego is *not* an inner object at all but the formal pole of acts; Husserl's analyses of habituality and time-consciousness answer real problems of identity over time that a strictly non-egological account must also solve.
- **Textual qualification** ✓: the opposition is **contested**. In the *Logical Investigations* Husserl himself denied finding an ego as an immanent item; the "pure ego" is admitted only later. Scholars such as **Dan Zahavi** therefore read Sartre as a **non-egological reorientation within phenomenology**, not a wholesale rejection of Husserl.
- **Residual force** ⚠: even so, the two projects diverge in *aim* — Husserl explains how objectivity is **constituted**; Sartre explains how a being that is nothing can be **free and self-deceiving**.
- **✗ Do not write:** "Sartre simply displaced Husserl." Write: "Sartre keeps intentionality and pre-reflective self-awareness, removes the ego from consciousness, and converts the resulting emptiness into an ontology of freedom."

2.4A.6 Presuppositions ⚠

- **P1:** intentionality is exhaustive — nothing is *in* consciousness except as its object.
- **P2:** consciousness is translucent; nothing opaque can inhabit it (this is what rules out both the ego and the Freudian unconscious, and generates bad faith instead of repression).
- **P3:** being-in-itself is fully positive and self-identical; "nothing" is intelligible only as the contrast to that plenitude.
- **P4:** reflection is a modification of consciousness, not a neutral observation of it.

2.4A.7 Traps ✗

- **✗** "Consciousness is nothing" = consciousness does not exist, or is an illusion. It means **no essence, no content, no self-coincidence**.
- **✗** Confusing Sartre's *néant* with Buddhist emptiness or Vedāntic negation; the reference class is Hegelian negativity and Husserlian intentionality (see ../indian/Buddhism.md only if the question demands a comparison).
- **✗** Attributing to Husserl the view that there is no ego (that is early Husserl and Sartre), or to Sartre the view that there is no self (there is — as a constituted, worldly object).
- **✗** Omitting the shared ground; a pure contrast answer reads as a textbook list.
- **✗** Dropping the *Transcendence of the Ego* reference, which is precisely where the 2026 difference is argued.

2.4A.8 Answer spine ⚠

15-mark (2026 Q2c: "Describe Sartre's notion of consciousness as 'nothing'. How is it different

from Husserl's notion of consciousness? Discuss.):

Frame : Both begin from intentionality; they divide over what, if anything, INHABITS consciousness.

Body A: Sartre – no contents; ego transcendent (Transcendence of the Ego); pre-reflective cogito;

"nothing" = lack of self-identical being; nihilation; Pierre's absence;

freedom.

Body B: Husserl – epoché and transcendental reduction; constituting subjectivity; the pure ego with
 habitualities; constitution of noematic sense.

Body C: contrast table in prose – ego, unifier, task, negation, freedom.

Qualif: LI-Husserl was himself non-egological; Zahavi reads Sartre as a reorientation, not a refutation.

Close : "For Husserl consciousness is that FOR WHICH the world has sense; for Sartre it is that

 BY WHICH nothingness – and therefore freedom – enters being."

10-mark rewording ("What does Sartre mean by consciousness as nothingness?"):

Definition → no contents/no ego → non-coincidence formula → nihilation and Pierre → freedom.

20-mark rewording ("Sartre's ontology of the for-itself and its phenomenological inheritance"):

Add en-soi/pour-soi (§2.4), bad faith as the consequence of translucency (§2.3), the Look (§2A),

and the objection that an absolutely free consciousness cannot be situated – with the later

Critique of Dialectical Reason concession (§2.6).

2026 route ✅ — Paper I, Section A, **Q2(c), 15 marks**: "Describe Sartre's notion of consciousness as 'nothing'. How is it different from Husserl's notion of consciousness? Discuss." Primary owner: this file, §2.4A (with §2.3, §2.4); Husserl's half cross-owned by Phenomenology-Husserl.md. See ../_PYQ-Western-Philosophy-2026.md.

Source anchors ✅ — SEP, *Jean-Paul Sartre*, §§2 and 4.1; SEP, *Edmund Husserl*, §2 (intentionality); primary texts: Sartre, *The Transcendence of the Ego* (1936–37) and *Being and Nothingness* (1943), Introduction and Part I ch. 1.

2.5 Choice as Legislating for All Humanity ⚠️

- Sartre adopts a quasi-Kantian universalisability principle: "In choosing myself, I choose man" — every choice implies an image of what human beings *ought* to be. If I choose to marry, I affirm that monogamy is valuable *for everyone*; I cannot choose "just for me" in moral isolation. ✅
- This generates the *weight* of responsibility and the anguish that accompanies it — I am not merely deciding my own fate but *legislating* an image of humanity.
- Objection:** this seems to conflict with the claim that there are no *a priori* values — whence the universalisability demand if no prior moral framework is given? Sartre's reply: the *form* of universalisability is inherent in the *structure* of free choice, not imported from a pre-existing ethics.
?

2.6 Sartre on Freedom and Determinism (PYQ 2019 — 15m) ✅

- In the early Sartrean account, causal, psychological and social explanations cannot convert the for-itself into a thing whose project is wholly fixed in advance.

- **Key argument:** a *motive* (desire, emotion, situation) can only become a reason for action through the *meaning* I confer on it. But meaning-conferral is itself an act of the pour-soi (nihilation/transcendence). Therefore, no motive determines me *unless I freely constitute it as a motive*. ✓
- **"There are no excuses"** expresses responsibility for taking up motives and situations; it should not become the psychologically implausible claim that trauma, illness, coercion or affect can simply be dismissed at will.
- **Situation and freedom:** Sartre does not deny that facticity limits practical possibilities. Early Sartre nevertheless calls freedom "absolute" in the structural sense that the for-itself cannot become a completed thing: it must take up a stance. This is not omnipotence, and coercion, trauma and social structures can constrain both action and the intelligibility of alternatives. ✓
- **Criticism:** is this psychologically and socially plausible? The Marxist critique: Sartre ignores structural oppression (poverty, racism) that limits not just physical but *cognitive* possibilities. Sartre partly concedes this later in the *Critique of Dialectical Reason* (1960), where he integrates material scarcity and seriality into his account. ⚠

2.7 Heidegger: Authenticity and Inauthenticity ✓

Important preliminary: for Heidegger, **authenticity (*Eigentlichkeit*)** is NOT a moral virtue and inauthenticity is NOT a moral failing. They are **existential modifications** — modes of Dasein's self-relation. Dasein is *mostly and for the most part* (*zunächst und zumeist*) inauthentic, and this is not a deficiency but a structural feature of being-in-the-world. ✓ (PYQ 2019, 2022 — direct demand to clarify this.)

Inauthenticity — *das Man* (the "they"): - Dasein exists with others (*Mitsein*) and tends to lose itself in what "one" (*man*) does, says, thinks — the anonymous public. - Three marks of *das Man*: **idle talk** (*Gerede* — passing along received opinions without genuine understanding); **curiosity** (*Neugier* — flitting restlessly from novelty to novelty); **ambiguity** (*Zweideutigkeit* — everything seems accessible, nothing genuinely appropriated). ✓ - **Falling** (*Verfallen*): Dasein's tendency to be absorbed in the world of its concern and in *das Man* — losing its "ownmost" self. Falling is not a theological "fall from grace"; it is an ontological structure. ✓

Authenticity (*Eigentlichkeit*): - **The call of conscience** (*Ruf des Gewissens*): Dasein is called back from dispersal in *das Man* to its null/groundless responsibility for taking over its thrown projection. The silent call gives no moral rule or substantive programme. ✓ - **Being-toward-death** (*Sein-zum-Tode*): death is Dasein's **ownmost** (no one can die for me), **non-relational** (isolates me from others), **certain** (inevitable), **indeterminate as to when** possibility. - Inauthentic relation: we flee death — "one dies" (*man stirbt*), "everyone dies someday" — covering over death's individualising force. - Authentic relation: **anticipatory resoluteness** (*vorlaufende Entschlossenheit*) — I face death as *my own* possibility, which discloses the finitude and urgency of my existence, freeing me from *das Man* and letting me take over my existence as a *whole*. ✓ - Individualisation by death does not abolish being-with or prescribe social withdrawal; authenticity modifies how Dasein owns its already social possibilities. - **Crucial correction:** authenticity for Heidegger does NOT mean "living a morally good life" or "being a rugged individualist." It means *owning* one's thrownness and projecting upon one's ownmost possibilities — it is a *formal* modification of everydayness, not a substantive ethical prescription. ⚠

2.8 Kierkegaard's Route to Authenticity — the Leap

- The "leap of faith" (*Troens Spring*): the passage from the ethical to the religious stage cannot be *mediated* by reason (contra Hegel, for whom everything is dialectically mediated).
- Faith is a *paradox*: to believe that the eternal has entered time (the Incarnation), that the universal ethical law can be suspended (Abraham), is *absurd* by rational standards. Yet it is the highest form of authentic existence — standing as a singular individual before God, without the comfort of the universal or the crowd. 
- **The "knight of faith"** (*Fear and Trembling*): outwardly indistinguishable from a bourgeois citizen (unlike the "knight of infinite resignation" who renounces the world visibly), the knight of faith lives fully in the finite world *while simultaneously* relating absolutely to the Absolute.

2.9 FEAR vs ANGST — the distinction the whole tradition turns on

This is the most frequently botched distinction in the item. Fear and anxiety are not degrees of the same thing; they differ in *what they are about*, and it is that difference that makes anxiety philosophically disclosive.

	FEAR (<i>Frygt</i> / <i>Furcht</i> / <i>peur</i>)	ANXIETY / DREAD / ANGUISH (<i>Angest</i> / <i>Angst</i> / <i>angoisse</i>)
Object	A determinate entity within the world — a dog, an examination, a fall	No determinate object. Kierkegaard: "the object of anxiety is a <i>nothing</i> ." Heidegger: that in the face of which one is anxious "is completely indefinite"
What it is really about	the threatening thing	Kierkegaard: <i>possibility</i> — my own "possibility of being able." Heidegger: <i>Being-in-the-world as such</i> . Sartre: <i>my own freedom</i>
Direction	I flee toward the world, seeking shelter in what is familiar	It individualises : the world's significance collapses, <i>das Man</i> falls away, and Dasein stands alone
Disclosive value	Discloses a threat	Discloses freedom, finitude and the groundlessness of existence — it is a privileged mood (<i>Grundbefindlichkeit</i>)
Canonical formula	—	 Kierkegaard: " anxiety is the dizziness of freedom " (<i>The Concept of Anxiety</i> , 1844); "a sympathetic antipathy and an antipathetic sympathy" — we are drawn to what we shrink from

The three canonical examples — learn one from each thinker : 1. **Kierkegaard (innocence):** the man standing at the edge of an abyss looks down and grows dizzy — but the dizziness is as much in the eye as in the abyss. In innocence there is no knowledge of good and evil, yet there is anxiety, because freedom's possibility is already sensed. Anxiety is the presupposition of the "leap" by which sin (and selfhood) enters. 2. **Heidegger (*Being and Time* §40):** in anxiety "**the world has the character of complete insignificance**" — the totality of involvements (the workshop of ready-to-hand things) collapses, and Dasein is thrown back on its bare *that-it-is*. Heidegger's compressed formula: **that in the face of which one is anxious and that for which one is anxious are the same — Being-in-the-world.** Anxiety therefore discloses Dasein as *solus ipse* and frees it for authentic choosing. -  In "What is

Metaphysics?" (1929) Heidegger adds that anxiety reveals *das Nichts* — the Nothing — which is the source of the phrase Carnap attacks. See Logical-Positivism.md §2.2 for the correct wording and Heidegger's reply. 3. **Sartre (*Being and Nothingness*, Part I)**: two examples, and both should be named. - **The cliff path**. Walking a narrow path above a precipice, I feel **fear** of the drop — of the loose stone, the gust of wind, the world's threat. But then I realise that **nothing prevents me from throwing myself over**: no barrier within me, no fixed nature. That vertigo is **anguish** — not fear of the abyss but anguish before my own freedom. - **The gambler**. A man has resolved firmly, yesterday, never to gamble again. Standing at the table today, he discovers that yesterday's resolution is *there* but **powerless** — it must be remade now, and nothing guarantees he will remake it. Anguish is this discovery that my past self cannot bind my present self.

The argument implicit in all three, numbered ⚠️ : 1. Moods (*Stimmungen*, *Befindlichkeit*) are not private colourings added to a neutral world; they are ways in which one's situation is *disclosed*. 2. Fear discloses an entity as threatening, and so keeps us within the world of concern. 3. Anxiety has no entity as its object; therefore it cannot disclose an entity. 4. Yet it plainly discloses something, since it has definite content and is not mere confusion. 5. ∴ What it discloses is not an entity but a **structure** — my freedom (Kierkegaard, Sartre) or Being-in-the-world as such (Heidegger). 6. ∴ Anxiety is philosophically privileged: it is the one mood in which existence as a whole becomes an issue for the existing individual.

Presuppositions ⚠️ : (P1) moods are cognitively disclosive, not merely affective — deny this and anxiety is only a symptom; (P2) there is a difference in kind, not degree, between an indefinite and a definite intentional object; (P3) what is disclosed in a rare mood is not thereby less real than what is disclosed in ordinary comportment. **Strongest objection** ? : the naturalist reply that anxiety is a pathological or neurochemical state with no cognitive credentials, and that treating it as a source of ontological insight is a category mistake. **Reply**: the existentialist claim is not that anxious people know more, but that the *structure* of the mood — having no object — is itself the datum requiring explanation, and no account of it in terms of an unnoticed object has succeeded.

2A. BOUNDED CORE: THE LOOK (*le regard*) AND BEING-FOR-OTHERS (*l'être-pour-autrui*) ✓

Bounded relevance. Being-for-others is necessary for questions on alienation, bad faith or intersubjectivity, but it must not displace the printed freedom/choice spine in every Sartre answer.

Exact printed subterms: *le regard* (the Look) · *l'être-pour-autrui* (being-for-others) · *la honte* (shame) · *le corps-pour-autrui* (the body-for-others) · "*objet-autrui*" / "*sujet-autrui*" · "*la chute originelle*" (the original fall) · *conflit* as "the original meaning of being-for-others."

Sartre's canonical example — the keyhole ✓ (learn the two stages exactly): | Stage | What is the case |
| --- | --- |
| 1. **Absorbed** | Out of jealousy or curiosity I am bent at a keyhole, looking through. I am wholly absorbed: there is *no ego* in my consciousness, only the scene and my project. Consciousness is **pre-reflective**, non-positional about itself. There is no self to be ashamed. |
| 2. **Caught** | Footsteps in the hall. **I am seen**. Instantly my whole being is transformed: I am no longer the pure surveying transcendence but a *peeping Tom*, an object with a nature, seen from outside, judged. |

The argument, numbered ✅: 1. In being looked at, I experience **shame** — and shame is not a private feeling I might have alone; it is by its structure **shame of myself before someone**. 2. ✅ **"Shame is by nature recognition"**: in being ashamed I *recognise* that I am as the Other sees me. I do not infer the Other; I *live* his presence as the condition of my own new mode of being. 3. The Other is not reached by an explicit inference. Sartre contrasts the Look with Husserlian appresentation and Heideggerian being-with, though neither rival is fairly reduced to an argument from analogy or neutral co-existence. **The Other is given as the subject for whom I am an object**. 4. ∴ ✅ **"The Other is the indispensable mediator between myself and me"**: I acquire an **outside**, a "nature," a being I *am* without having chosen it and without being able to know it from within — my *being-for-others*. 5. The Look reveals a dimension of facticity: meanings of my acts and body are constituted from a perspective I cannot control. This is one limit on mastery, not the only constraint Sartre recognises. 6. **The dialectic of concrete relations (Part III, ch. 3)**. Since I am objectified by the Other's freedom, I can respond in only two directions, and both fail: | Attitude | Strategy | Forms | Why it fails | |---|---|---| | **(a) Assimilate the Other's freedom** — possess the freedom that judges me *while it remains free* | make myself the object the Other freely chooses | **love**, language, **masochism** | Love wants to be loved *freely* — but to be loved is to be made an object, so the very freedom sought is destroyed in the possessing. Masochism collapses because I cannot succeed in being pure object while remaining conscious. | | **(b) Transcend the Other's freedom** — reduce him to an object so his look cannot fix me | make the Other into an object | **indifference, desire, sadism, hate** | An object cannot confer the recognition I wanted; the moment he looks back, the whole structure reverses. Hate wants the Other's *disappearance*, which would leave my being-for-others intact. | 7. ∴ ✅ **"Conflict is the original meaning of being-for-others."** The famous line of *Huis clos* (*No Exit*, 1944) — "**L'enfer, c'est les autres**" ("Hell is other people") — follows from this.

⚠️ **Quote it, then correct the popular misreading.** Sartre himself explained (in a 1965 recorded preface to the play) that the line does **not** mean relations with others are always poisonous; it means that if one's relations with others are twisted, then the Other's judgement becomes the medium of one's own self-torment — and that the three characters in the play are dead, i.e. fixed, unable to change their acts. Making this correction is a high-value move.

Presuppositions ⚠️: (P1) shame is irreducibly relational and cannot be analysed away as self-assessment; (P2) pre-reflective consciousness is egoless, so the ego that appears under the Look is genuinely *conferred*; (P3) subject and object are exclusive — I cannot be looked-at and looking in the same act, which is what makes reciprocity impossible; (P4) there is no third term (a "we-subject" of the kind Marxists posit) that could stabilise the relation. Sartre discusses and rejects it in Part III.

Comparison — the four accounts of the Other ⚠️ **(a table worth memorising)**: | Thinker | How the Other is reached | Basic relation | |---|---|---| | **Husserl** | passive pairing and appresentation, not a discursive analogy-inference | The Other is non-originally given; ownness-first circularity remains. See *Phenomenology-Husserl*.md §3A | | **Heidegger** | Dasein is always already being-with (*Mitsein*) | Social existence is constitutive, though Sartre presses for the conflictual concrete encounter | | **Sartre** | the **Look** — the Other is revealed in the *shame* of being objectified | **Conflict**; recognition is structurally unattainable | | **Levinas** | the **face** (*visage*) of the Other, which commands before it is known | **Ethical asymmetry** — responsibility precedes freedom; explicitly a reply to both Husserl and Sartre |

Strongest objections → **replies** ? : | Objection | Reply | Residual | |---|---|---| | Sartre generalises from a small set of **pathological** encounters (the peeping Tom, sadism, seduction) to the structure of all human relations. | Sartre's claim is ontological, not statistical: he analyses the *possibility-conditions* of any relation, and conflict is the structure even where it is unnoticed. | ⚠️ Strong objection; Sartre himself moves toward a more social account in the *Critique of Dialectical Reason* (1960), where the "group-in-fusion" allows non-objectifying solidarity. That development is the best evidence the objection landed. | | Shame is not the primitive datum; **love, trust and being-cared-for** are equally basic and are not objectifications. | Sartre analyses love (§6(a)) and argues its internal contradiction. | ? The analysis is compelling only if one accepts P3 (subject/object exclusivity). | | **Levinas**: to encounter the Other only as a rival freedom is still to think him from the self. | — | ⚠️ Sartre has no reply within *Being and Nothingness*; this is the strongest single line of criticism. |

Executable verdict: the Look gives a powerful non-inferential account of being exposed to another perspective, but Sartre may generalise conflict from selective examples. Later solidarity, feminist and postcolonial accounts test rather than simply repeat the subject/object model.

2B. KIERKEGAARD — INDIRECT COMMUNICATION AND PSEUDONYMITY ✓

Why it is examinable. Kierkegaard's use of pseudonyms is not literary decoration; it is a **direct consequence of the doctrine that truth is subjectivity**. A question on "truth is subjectivity" or on Kierkegaard's critique of Hegel is incomplete without it, and the point is almost never made in ordinary scripts.

The problem, numbered ✓ : 1. Objective truth — historical, scientific, metaphysical — can be transmitted **directly**: I state a result, you receive it, and nothing about your existence need change. 2. But ethical and religious truth is not merely a result; it is a **mode of existing**, an appropriation in inwardness. ✓ Climacus's "truth is subjectivity" in the *Postscript* concerns the *how* of relation without abolishing objective truth. 3. If such truth were communicated **directly**, the recipient would take it over as a *result* — as information, as doctrine, as something one can know without becoming. The communication would thereby **falsify** exactly what it communicates. 4. ∴ Ethical-religious truth requires **indirect communication** (*indirekte Meddelelse*): a form that withholds the result, refuses to be an authority, and forces the reader to relate to the possibility **for himself**. 5. The model is **Socratic maieutics** — the midwife who brings to birth what the other must produce, and who, in Kierkegaard's phrase, "**deceives into the truth**." The author must become a *vanishing* occasion, not a teacher with a doctrine. 6. ∴ **Pseudonymity**. The pseudonyms are not disguises for a shy author but **personified existence-possibilities** — each writes from *within* a sphere of existence and cannot see beyond it.

The pseudonyms and their standpoints — the table to reproduce ✓ : | Pseudonym | Work (year) | Standpoint written from | |---|---|---| | **Victor Eremita** (editor) | *Either/Or* (1843) | presents the aesthetic ("A") and ethical (Judge William) papers side by side without deciding between them — the reader must choose | | **Johannes de Silentio** | *Fear and Trembling* (1843) | one who admires faith but **does not have it**; hence the "silence" — he can describe Abraham but not understand him | | **Constantin Constantius** | *Repetition* (1843) | the aesthetic-experimental observer | | **Vigilius Haufniensis** ("watchman of Copenhagen") | *The Concept of Anxiety* (1844) | psychological observer of anxiety, deliberately *not* a dogmatist | | **Johannes Climacus** | *Philosophical Fragments* (1844); *Concluding Unscientific Postscript*

(1846) | a **humorist** who is explicitly **not a Christian** — which is why he can pose the problem of becoming one | | **Anti-Climacus** | *The Sickness unto Death* (1849); *Practice in Christianity* (1850) | a Christian at an **extraordinarily high** level — above Kierkegaard himself, deliberately the mirror image of Climacus |

⚠ Kierkegaard also published, **simultaneously and under his own name**, the *Upbuilding/Edifying Discourses*. The "**double authorship**" is deliberate: the signed religious writings stand beside the pseudonymous works as the direct pole of a single strategy. Saying this shows you understand pseudonymity as a *method*, not an evasion.

Kierkegaard's own instruction ✅ — the "**First and Last Declaration**" appended to the *Postscript* (1846): he acknowledges authorship of the pseudonymous books while insisting that he is only their "author's author," a **prompter** (*souffleur*) who has produced characters, and he asks that anyone citing them **quote the pseudonym's name, not his**. ⚠ **Follow this in your answers:** write "Johannes de Silentio argues..." or "Climacus holds..." — it is textually correct and instantly visible as expertise. ❌ Writing "Kierkegaard says in *Fear and Trembling*..." ignores an instruction the author printed.

Presuppositions ⚠ : (P1) there is a genuine category of truth that cannot be held without being lived; (P2) the reader's freedom must be protected from the author's authority; (P3) the pseudonymous voices are internally coherent standpoints, not the author speaking with a mask.

Strongest objections → **replies** ? : | Objection | Reply | Residual | |---|---|---| | Indirect communication makes Kierkegaard's own position **unattributable** — one can never pin him down, so the method insulates him from criticism. | The signed discourses and *The Point of View for My Work as an Author* (written 1848, published posthumously 1859) provide the direct pole and an explicit account of the strategy. | ⚠ *The Point of View* is itself a retrospective self-interpretation and is disputed as evidence. | | If subjective truth cannot be said directly, then the *thesis* "truth is subjectivity" cannot be said directly either — the method is self-undermining. | Climacus concedes precisely this: the *Postscript* ends by **revoking** itself, and Kierkegaard's texts are, like the *Tractatus*'s ladder, meant to be discarded. | ⚠ **A first-class exam observation:** Kierkegaard, the early Wittgenstein (6.54) and Hegel's Unhappy Consciousness all end with a text that consumes itself. Cross-link Moore-Russell-EarlyWittgenstein.md §6.6 and Hegel1.md §1.8. | | Hegelian reply: the "existing individual" whose truth cannot be systematised is simply an unreflective stage that philosophy sublates. | Kierkegaard: no system can contain the one who *builds* it; the systematiser must still exist, choose and die. "A logical system is possible; an existential system is impossible." | ⚠ This is the sharpest single sentence to deploy in any Kierkegaard-vs-Hegel question. |

Executable verdict: "Pseudonymity is the formal counterpart of the doctrine that truth is subjectivity: because ethical-religious truth is a mode of existing rather than a result, it can be communicated only in a form that refuses to deliver a result. The method's cost is that it is self-consuming — Climacus revokes the *Postscript* — and its power is that the cost is intended. Kierkegaard is not evading the demand for a position; he is denying that a position, in the systematic sense Hegel required, is the sort of thing an existing individual can hand over."

3. BEING-IN-THE-WORLD AND TEMPORALITY ✓

3.0 Being-question and ontological difference

- Heidegger's project is **fundamental ontology**, not an existentialist psychology or a general ethics of authenticity.
- The **ontological difference** distinguishes Being—the intelligibility in virtue of which entities show up as entities—from particular beings. Being is not one supreme entity.
- Dasein is selected because it already has a pre-ontological understanding of Being and its own Being is at issue for it.
- Existential analysis is therefore the route toward the Being-question; moods, death and authenticity are not isolated psychological topics.

3.1 Dasein and Being-in-the-World (*In-der-Welt-sein*) (PYQ 2022 — 20m) ✓

- **Dasein** ("being-there"): the entity each of us is insofar as its own Being is at issue and it understands Being. It is not merely a biological synonym for *human being*. ✓
- **Being-in-the-world** is a *unitary* phenomenon — a single hyphenated structure, NOT three separate elements (subject + relation + world). It is intended to dissolve the Cartesian split between an inner subject and an external world.
- Dasein does not first *exist* and then subsequently *encounter* a world; it IS constitutively *in* a world — practically engaged, absorbed, concerned. ✓

3.2 The Worldhood of the World ✓

- The "world" is not the totality of physical objects (the universe of natural science); it is the **referential context** of meaning within which things show up as significant.
- **Ready-to-hand** (*Zuhandenheit*): the primary mode in which we encounter entities — as *equipment* (tools, instruments) that we *use* in a practical context. The hammer is not first "an object with properties" and then "used for hammering"; it is *originally* encountered as equipment-for-hammering, within a totality of references (nails, wood, house, shelter, project). ✓
- **Present-at-hand** (*Vorhandenheit*): entities are thematised as objects with properties, a mode prominent in theoretical inquiry. ✓
- **Breakdown analysis**: unusability, absence or obstruction first makes the equipment-network conspicuous and can open a shift toward explicit object-thematisation. Breakdown does not instantly erase all practical significance.
- **The referential totality**: every piece of equipment refers beyond itself — the hammer to the nail, the nail to the board, the board to the house, the house to dwelling-as-a-way-of-being. This "in-order-to" (*Um-zu*) structure constitutes the worldhood of the world as a meaningful whole. ✓

3.3 The Existentialia ✓

Heidegger replaces the traditional "categories" (which apply to things) with **existentialia** — the structures of Dasein's being:

Existentiale	German	Meaning
Attunement / State-of-mind	<i>Befindlichkeit</i>	Dasein always already finds itself in a <i>mood</i> (Stimmung) — anxiety, boredom, joy. Mood is not a subjective "colouring" of an objectively given world; it is a fundamental mode of <i>disclosing</i> the world and one's situation. "We are always already attuned." ✓
Understanding	<i>Verstehen</i>	Dasein projects itself upon possibilities — it <i>understands</i> its world in terms of what it can do, what is possible. Understanding is not theoretical cognition but practical <i>know-how</i> and projection upon potentiality-for-being. ✓
Discourse	<i>Rede</i>	The articulation of understanding — Dasein's being-open to meaning is always linguistically structured. Discourse is the condition of possibility of both speech and listening. ✓

- These three (Befindlichkeit, Verstehen, Rede) constitute the **disclosedness** (*Erschlossenheit*) of Dasein — the "there" (*Da*) of Da-sein: the fact that Being is *disclosed* or opened up for this entity.

3.4 Care (*Sorge*) as the Being of Dasein ✓

- **Care** is the unitary structural whole of Dasein's existence. Its formal definition:

"Ahead-of-itself — already-in (a world) — alongside (entities encountered within-the-world)" (*Sich-vorweg — schon-sein-in — Sein-bei*)

- **"Ahead-of-itself"** = Dasein is always *projecting* toward its future possibilities (understanding, freedom).
- **"Already-in"** = Dasein is always *thrown* into a world and a situation it did not choose (facticity, attunement).
- **"Alongside"** = Dasein is always *absorbed* in its practical dealings with entities (concern, falling).
- Care is not a psychological attitude (worry, anxiety) but the **ontological structure** that makes all particular attitudes and activities possible. ✓

3.5 Temporality (*Zeitlichkeit*) as the Meaning of Care (PYQ 2019 — 20m) ✓

The central thesis of Division Two of *Being and Time*: the meaning of Care (and therefore of Dasein's being) is **temporality**.

- **Three ecstases of primordial temporality:**

Ecstasis	Existential moment	Structural element of Care
Future (<i>Zukunft</i>) — "coming toward" oneself	Projection, anticipation, being-toward-death	"Ahead-of-itself"
Having-been (<i>Gewesenheit</i>) — the past that I <i>still am</i>	Thrownness, facticity, guilt	"Already-in"
Present (<i>Gegenwart</i>) — "making present"	Absorption in entities, practical engagement	"Alongside"

- **Priority of the future:** for Heidegger, the future (as Dasein's projecting upon its ownmost possibility — death) is the primary ecstasis. The past and present are *temporalised* from out of the future. Authenticity is *futural*: in anticipatory resoluteness, Dasein runs ahead to its death and thereby gathers its existence into a *whole*. ✓
- **"Ecstatic" temporality:** the three dimensions are not containers or segments of a line; they are "ecstases" — Dasein *stands out* (*ek-stasis*) into each simultaneously. Temporality is a *unity* of future-past-present in which Dasein holds itself open. ✓

3.6 Primordial vs Vulgar/Ordinary Time ✓

Primordial temporality (<i>Zeitlichkeit</i>)	Vulgar / ordinary time (<i>innerzeitige Zeit</i>)
Ecstatic, finite, unified, futural	A sequence of "nows" — past nows (gone), present now (here), future nows (not yet)
The temporality of <i>Dasein</i> — how Dasein exists its own being	"Time" as measured by clocks — the time <i>in which</i> events occur
Finite — bounded by death	Infinite — the "now" series is endless (both directions)
More primordial existential condition	Derived public/world-time interpretation and clock measurement

- Heidegger derives ordinary now-time through world-time and public dating from more primordial temporality. Levelled interpretation can accompany falling, but clock-time is not thereby morally defective or practically dispensable. ✓
- Ordinary/world time is derivative from Dasein's temporality and practical dating, but clock measurement is not simply false or morally inauthentic. "Vulgar" names a levelled conceptual interpretation.
- **Historicity (*Geschichtlichkeit*) of Dasein:** Dasein inherits possibilities and projects them; history is an existential structure rather than merely an external sequence. ✓

4. CRITICISMS AND REPLIES ⚠️

4.1 Criticisms of Sartre

Criticism	Source	Reply / Counter
Radical freedom is psychologically implausible — people under extreme oppression (slavery, torture, mental illness) are not "absolutely free"	Common sense; Marxist tradition (Merleau-Ponty, <i>Adventures of the Dialectic</i>)	Sartre distinguishes freedom-of-consciousness (always present — I can always <i>interpret</i>) from freedom-of-action (limited by situation). But this weakens the radical thesis. In the <i>Critique of Dialectical Reason</i> (1960), Sartre himself integrates scarcity, seriality, and the "practico-inert" — acknowledging material constraints far more than in <i>Being and Nothingness</i> . ⚠️
Bad faith presupposes what it denies — to deceive myself, I must both know and not know the truth; but Sartre rejects the Freudian unconscious. How is self-deception possible for a fully transparent consciousness?	Analytic philosophy of mind (Fingarette, <i>Self-Deception</i>)	Sartre's answer: the pour-soi's non-self-identity allows a <i>pre-reflective</i> awareness that is not <i>thetically</i> posited — I "know" at the pre-reflective level but do not reflectively avow it. Whether this is coherent remains debated. ?
Choice without criteria is blind — if there are no <i>a priori</i> values, on what basis do I choose? Sartre's freedom risks becoming <i>arbitrary</i> (existentialist "decisionism")	Iris Murdoch, <i>The Sovereignty of Good</i> ; Marxist critics	Sartre replies that the very <i>engagement</i> of choice generates its own criteria — but critics find this circular.
The universalisability requirement (§2.5) sits uneasily with the denial of objective values	Kantians, communitarians	Sartre concedes tension; the later <i>Notebooks for an Ethics</i> (posthumous) attempts a more substantive ethics but was never completed. ?
Radical freedom under-describes gendered, racialised and material constraint	de Beauvoir, Fanon, feminist/postcolonial criticism	Situated freedom can appropriate facticity without being reducible to it; later Sartre broadens social mediation, but the early vocabulary remains abstract.

4.2 Criticisms of Heidegger

Criticism	Source	Reply / Counter
Obscurity — <i>Being and Time</i> is deliberately obscure; neologisms obstruct rather than clarify	Carnap (1932), Ayer, Russell, analytic tradition generally	Heidegger: ordinary language is saturated with the metaphysical tradition; new terms are needed to <i>break through</i> to the phenomena themselves. Whether this justifies the opacity is contested. ?
Fundamental ontology never delivered its second half — Division III of <i>Being and Time</i> (Time and Being) was never published; the project was abandoned	Internal	Heidegger acknowledged this and underwent the "turn" (<i>Kehre</i>) — moving from Dasein-analytic toward the history of Being, language, and art. Whether this is a failure or a deepening is debated. ?

Criticism	Source	Reply / Counter
Authenticity is formally empty — it prescribes no <i>content</i> ; a Nazi could be "authentic"	Political critics (given Heidegger's own 1933 complicity)	Heidegger: authenticity is deliberately non-prescriptive; it does not tell you <i>what</i> to choose, only <i>how</i> — owning your existence. But many find this ethically irresponsible. ⚠️
Being-toward-death is morbid / excludes positive social bonds	Emmanuel Levinas (ethics of the Other), Hannah Arendt (natality over mortality)	Heidegger: death is not morbidity but the disclosure of finitude that makes <i>any</i> authentic engagement possible — including care for others. But Levinas's alternative (the face of the Other as primary) remains a powerful counter. ⚠️
Ontological formality permits political ambiguity	Critics linking empty resoluteness to Heidegger's 1933 politics	Fundamental ontology is not a political programme; that defence is textually relevant but does not settle whether formal authenticity lacks critical norms.

4.3 Criticisms of Kierkegaard

Criticism	Source	Reply / Counter
Fideism / irrationalism — the "leap of faith" abandons rationality; this is intellectually irresponsible	Hegel (implicitly), analytic philosophy of religion	Kierkegaard: the <i>point</i> is that rationality cannot encompass the existential truth of faith. Reason is not <i>wrong</i> but <i>limited</i> — it cannot deliver what the religious individual needs. Whether this is a reductio of Kierkegaard or a valid critique of rationalism depends on one's epistemology. ?
Elitism of the individual — by elevating the singular individual over the community, Kierkegaard undermines ethics and social responsibility	Communitarian critics, Hegelians	Kierkegaard: the "crowd is untruth" precisely because it enables ethical evasion; genuine responsibility requires the individual to stand alone (before God or before the ethical demand).
"Truth is subjectivity" collapses into relativism	Common misreading	Standard reply: Kierkegaard distinguishes <i>what</i> is believed from <i>how</i> it is believed. "Truth is subjectivity" concerns the <i>mode of appropriation</i> , not the propositional content. He does not deny objective truth for logic/science; he denies its <i>sufficiency</i> for existential/religious truth. ⚠️
Anxiety, despair and faith produce a pessimistic or elitist ideal of solitary existence	Secular and social critics	Kierkegaard treats despair as a universal structural possibility and responsibility as individual; the limited account of institutions/community remains a genuine weakness.

4.4 Movement-level objections require thinker-specific replies

- **Subjectivism/irrationalism:** Kierkegaard's subjectivity concerns appropriation, Sartre links choice with responsibility, and Heidegger is doing ontology rather than validating opinion.

- **Pessimism:** anxiety, despair, death and nothingness are diagnostic/disclosive structures for these thinkers, not the claim that every life is emotionally miserable.
- **Social abstraction:** feminist, Marxist and postcolonial critics rightly pressure the early focus on solitary or formally free agents; facticity, being-with and later situated ethics provide partial rather than complete replies.

4A. MARKS-ESSENTIAL OWNER CONTENT AND OPTIONAL ENRICHMENT

Core owner

-  Kierkegaard: existing individual, subjective appropriation, spheres, choice/anxiety/despair, faith and anti-Hegel critique.
-  Sartre: existence/essence, in-itself/for-itself, nothingness, facticity/transcendence, freedom, bad faith and responsibility.
-  Heidegger: Being-question, Dasein, being-in-the-world, care, authenticity and temporality.
-  All sixteen routed PYQs with thinker-specific answer routes.

Bounded prerequisites

-  Sartre's Look/being-for-others and Kierkegaard's pseudonymity are needed for high-quality ownership and intersubjectivity answers.
-  Husserlian reduction and Hegelian system remain comparison-context.
-  Later Sartre/de Beauvoir/Fanon may supply one constraint or ethics objection only.

Cross-owned or optional

-  Nietzsche is not named in the printed clause; nihilism, will to power, recurrence and overhuman doctrine are not owner content.
-  Marcel, Jaspers, Camus and de Beauvoir are not printed owner-thinkers.
-  Full political theory, later Marxist Sartre and postcolonial/feminist systems remain bounded enrichment.
-  Quine and Strawson remain the next locked topic.

5. COMMON UPSC TRAPS

Trap	Correction
"Existence precedes essence" is shared by all three	Wrong. It is Sartre's slogan. Heidegger explicitly disowned it as a humanistic misreading. Kierkegaard never used this phrase.
The official "Sarte" names a fourth thinker	No. It is a printed misspelling of Sartre.
Existentialism is one unified doctrine	No. Religious existence, phenomenological ontology and atheistic humanism form a contested family.

Trap	Correction
Kierkegaard's "truth is subjectivity" = relativism	Wrong. It concerns the <i>mode of appropriation</i> (passionate inwardness), not a denial of objective truth.
Heidegger's authenticity = moral goodness	Wrong. It is a formal/ontological modification of everydayness, not a moral category. An inauthentic person is not morally bad; an authentic one is not morally good.
Sartre's <i>en-soi</i> = "matter" and <i>pour-soi</i> = "mind"	Wrong. En-soi is being-that-is-what-it-is (self-identical); pour-soi is being-that-is-not-what-it-is (nihilating consciousness). This is an <i>ontological</i> , not a mind-matter, distinction.
Sartre and Heidegger agree on freedom	Wrong. Sartre's freedom is <i>absolute</i> and centred on the choosing <i>subject</i> . Heidegger's is <i>ontological</i> — Dasein is <i>thrown projection</i> , but this is about Being's disclosure, not voluntaristic self-creation.
Kierkegaard's stages are chronological/developmental	Misleading. They are <i>qualitative spheres</i> , not temporal stages. One does not "grow out of" the aesthetic by maturation; one <i>leaps</i> . And relapse is always possible.
Heidegger's "being-toward-death" = contemplating suicide or fearing death	Wrong. It is the disclosure of death as one's <i>ownmost possibility</i> — it individualises and frees Dasein for authentic existence. It is NOT about the empirical event of dying.
Heidegger is merely an existentialist psychologist	No. Moods, care and death serve fundamental ontology and the Being-question.
Sartrean freedom means constraints are unreal	No. Facticity constrains possibilities; the early claim concerns how situations acquire meaning and are taken up.
Nietzsche/Camus/de Beauvoir are printed owner-thinkers	No. They may enrich criticism but must not displace Kierkegaard, Sartre and Heidegger.

6. KEYWORD & STATEMENT BANK

#	Term / Statement	Thinker	Significance
1	✓ "Existence precedes essence"	Sartre	No fixed human nature; man is a self-making project
2	✓ "Man is condemned to be free"	Sartre	Freedom is inescapable; it is our being, not a property
3	✓ "In choosing myself I choose man"	Sartre	Choice implies universal legislation (quasi-Kantian)
4	✓ "Consciousness is what it is not and is not what it is"	Sartre	Non-self-identity of the pour-soi via nihilation
5	⚠ "Hell is other people" (<i>No Exit/Huis Clos</i>)	Sartre	Dramatic line about conflict/objectification; not a complete theory of all relations
6	✓ "Truth is subjectivity"	Johannes Climacus (Kierkegaard pseudonym)	Mode of appropriation for existential/religious truth, not factual relativism

#	Term / Statement	Thinker	Significance
7	✓ "The crowd is untruth"	Kierkegaard	Authentic existence requires standing alone
8	✓ "The essence of Dasein lies in its existence"	Heidegger	Dasein's "what" = its "how" — its manner of being
9	✓ "Ahead-of-itself — already-in — alongside"	Heidegger	Formal structure of Care (<i>Sorge</i>)
10	✓ Being-toward-death (<i>Sein-zum-Tode</i>)	Heidegger	Death as ownmost, non-relational, certain possibility
11	✓ The "they" (<i>das Man</i>)	Heidegger	Anonymous public self and inauthentic absorption
12	✓ Teleological suspension of the ethical	Johannes de Silentio (Kierkegaard pseudonym)	Abraham stages the paradox of faith; not a simple moral licence
13	⚠ Pour-soi = nihilation; en-soi = plenitude	Sartre	The ontological dualism of <i>Being and Nothingness</i>
14	⚠ "Shepherd of Being" (Letter on Humanism)	Heidegger	Man is not the lord of beings but the guardian of Being

RESTORED 2018/2020 DOCTRINE DOSSIER

Sartre: bad faith, inauthenticity and alienation

- ✓ Bad faith is the project of treating oneself as only facticity or only transcendence in order to flee responsibility. Inauthenticity follows because consciousness denies its own unstable freedom; alienation follows when the self lives through fixed social roles or the objectifying look.
- ✓ **Canonical examples:** the over-scripted waiter and the person who postpones recognising the meaning of another's gesture.
- ? **Objection** → **reply:** radical freedom can ignore oppression and circumstance. Sartre's reply appeals to situated freedom: one always chooses from a factual situation, not from nowhere.

Heidegger against the transcendental ego

- ✓ Epoché begins from a reflective suspension, whereas Heidegger argues that the more primordial condition is Dasein's already-involved being-in-the-world. Subject and object are derivative abstractions from practical involvement.
- ⚠ Heidegger does not merely reject careful phenomenological description; he redirects it from transcendental consciousness to the disclosedness of Being through care, equipment and temporality.
- ✗ Do not equate being-in-the-world with spatial containment or with Sartrean consciousness.

CORPUS-DRIVEN DEPTH DELTA (complete 2018–2025 audit)

- ⚠ **Priority:** Primary ownership rises to 14 of 112 parts, joint-highest, with at least one part in every year.

-  **Required doctrinal depth:** The restored papers add Sartrean inauthenticity–bad faith–alienation, Heidegger’s rejection of transcendental reduction through being-in-the-world, Kierkegaard’s single individual and Sartre’s facticity–transcendence formula.
-  **Trap / answer consequence:** Do not merge Heidegger’s critique of the transcendental ego with Sartrean bad faith; state each thinker’s problem, ontology of the agent and criterion of authenticity.

7. PYQ ROUTING (2018–2025)

 **Corpus signal:** 14 primary-owned question-parts out of 112. The local Paper I corpus is continuous from 2018 through 2025. Cross-links do not create duplicate ownership.

Year	Question	Marks	Exact demand	Answer route
2018	Q1(d)	10 marks	How does Sartre connect inauthenticity with bad faith? Why does Sartre show that inauthenticity and bad faith lead to alienation? Discuss.	facticity/transcendence evasion → waiter/date examples cautiously → self-alienation → authenticity difficulty
2018	Q4(a)	20 marks	What is 'Epoché'? How does Heidegger reject this method of phenomenological reduction? Explain Heidegger's concept of 'being in the world' as opposed to the concept of a transcendental ego.	Husserlian suspension → Heidegger's Being-question → Dasein/world unity → care/equipment → anti-subjectivist verdict
2019	Q3(a)	20 marks	Is Dasein authentic existence for Heidegger? How does he relate temporality with Dasein? Discuss.	Dasein not authenticity → they/falling → conscience/death → care's temporal ecstases → formal-emptiness objection
2019	Q4(c)	15 marks	How does Sartre look at the problem of freedom of choice and determinism? Explain.	for-itself/nihilation → motive meaning → facticity/situation → structural constraint criticism
2020	Q3(a)	20 marks	What does Kierkegaard mean by saying "Subjectivity is the truth" in the context of the problem of 'the single individual'?	Climacus attribution → appropriation not relativism → existing individual/Hegel → indirect communication → fideism verdict

Year	Question	Marks	Exact demand	Answer route
2020	Q4(a)	20 marks	"You can always make something out of what you have been made into." Critically discuss this statement by Sartre with reference to his views on existentialism.	facticity versus transcendence → situated project → no excuses qualified → oppression/late Sartre
2021	Q4(b)	15 marks	"I can always choose, but I ought to know that if I do not choose, I am still choosing". Critically discuss Sartre's conception of choice and responsibility in the light of above statement.	non-choice as stance → responsibility/anguish → bad-faith evasion → coercion and inability objection
2022	Q2(a)	20 marks	Provide a critical account of Heidegger's Being-in-the-world and discuss the problem of 'authenticity' in the context of Dasein.	unitary being-in-world → worldhood/equipment → care → they/death/resoluteness → non-moral/political critique
2022	Q4(a)	20 marks	How does Soren Kierkegaard define the notion of 'subjectivity'? Explain it with reference to three stages of existence as propounded by him.	pseudonymous attribution → how/appropriation → aesthetic/ethical/religious spheres → qualitative leap
2023	Q1(d)	10 marks	How does Kierkegaard argue against Hegel's idea of universal spirit in favour of the individual as the essence of spirit? Critically discuss.	existing individual → system closure → choice/death → Hegel reply → bounded verdict
2023	Q3(c)	15 marks	"Consciousness is what it is not and is not what it is." In the light of this statement bring out the chief features of Sartre's conception of consciousness.	in-itself/for-itself → nihilation → temporality/project → bad faith → coherence objection
2024	Q1(e)	10 marks	How does Kierkegaard define truth in terms of subjectivity? Critically discuss.	Climacus → objective truth retained → existential appropriation → faith/fideism caution

Year	Question	Marks	Exact demand	Answer route
2024	Q4(a)	20 marks	What do the existentialist thinkers mean by the slogan "existence precedes essence"? How is human existence related to human freedom according to them? Discuss.	Sartre-owned slogan → Kierkegaard/Heidegger differences → three freedom concepts → family-label verdict
2025	Q1(c)	10 marks	Explain the difference between being-for-itself and being-in-itself as presented by Sartre.	English-first definitions → self-identity/non-identity → nothingness/freedom → impossible synthesis

See the Western Philosophy PYQ Bank, 2018–2025.

2026 additions

Year	Question	Marks	Exact demand	Owner status
2026	Q2(c)	15 marks	Describe Sartre's notion of consciousness as 'nothing'. How is it different from Husserl's notion of consciousness? Discuss.	primary — §2.4A; Husserl's half cross-owned by Phenomenology-Husserl.md
2026	Q3(b)	15 marks	Explain Heidegger's conception of authenticity and inauthenticity as modes of Dasein's being.	primary — §2.7, with §3.1–3.5 (Dasein, das Man, Care, temporality)

See the Western Philosophy PYQ Bank, 2026.

8. ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

8.1 — PYQ 2025 Q1(c) 10m: "Explain the difference between pour-soi and en-soi."

Defn : Being-in-itself (en-soi) = being that is what it is—full, self-identical, opaque.

Being-for-itself (pour-soi) = being that is not what it is and is not what it is – consciousness, nihilation, self-surpassing.

Body : En-soi: solid, complete, non-relational (a stone simply IS). Pour-soi: introduces

nothingness – questions, negates, projects beyond the given. Constituted by freedom.

Key formula: consciousness "is what it is not" (projects toward a future it doesn't have)

and "is not what it is" (transcends its facticity/past).
Close : The pour-soi perpetually seeks to become en-soi (self-identical) – to be a "for-itself-in-itself" (= God) – but this is a contradictory ideal. Human reality is defined by this impossible desire: hence "man is a useless passion."

8.2 — PYQ 2024 Q4(a) 10+10m: "Existence precedes essence + freedom."

Frame : Sartre's central reversal, not the common formula of every existentialist.
Part 1 : The paper-knife analogy (Sartre): essence (design) precedes existence for artefacts;
but there is no divine artisan for man → existence first, essence self-created.
Kierkegaard: the System (Hegel) cannot account for the existing individual.
Heidegger: "the essence of Dasein lies in its existence" – but rejects the humanist reading (Letter on Humanism).
Part 2 : Freedom—without a predetermined blueprint, Sartre makes project inescapable but
situated by facticity. Responsibility follows; Kierkegaard and Heidegger use
choosing, I choose an image of man (quasi-Kantian universalisability).
Heidegger: freedom = Dasein's projection upon possibilities (not voluntarism).
Kierkegaard: freedom is real but bounded – the leap presupposes that one CAN choose.
Assess : The primacy of existence over essence empowers a radical ethics of responsibility; but
critics ask whether ungrounded freedom can generate actual values without collapsing into decisionism.

8.3 — PYQ 2023 Q3(c) 15m: "Consciousness is what it is not and is not what it is."

Frame : This formula captures Sartre's ontology of the pour-soi – human consciousness as
constitutively non-self-identical, in contrast to the en-soi (which IS what it IS).
Body A : "Is what it is not" – consciousness is always AHEAD of itself, projecting toward
possibilities not yet realised. It IS defined by its future (which does not yet exist).
Body B : "Is not what it is" – consciousness CANNOT coincide with its

facticity/past.

The waiter "is" a waiter but simultaneously "is not" – he transcends the role.

Body C : How this is possible: NIHILATION (néantisation). The pour-soi secretes nothingness;

it stands back from what is (questions, negates, imagines alternatives).

Assess : This accounts for freedom, bad faith, and the perpetual restlessness of consciousness.

Criticism: is "non-self-identity" coherent, or is it a contradiction dressed up in

phenomenological language?

Close : The formula is the key to Sartre's entire system – it grounds freedom, bad faith,

temporality, and the "useless passion" of the pour-soi's desire to be en-soi.

8.4 — PYQ 2022 Q2(a) 20m: "Being-in-the-world and authenticity."

Frame : Being-in-the-world is the fundamental constitution of Dasein; authenticity is a

modification **within** that structure, not an escape from it.

Body A : Being-in-the-world as unitary – dissolves subject/object split.

Worldhood: ready-to-

hand (equipment, referential totality) vs present-at-hand (theoretical staring, derived).

Existentialia: Befindlichkeit (attunement), Verstehen (understanding/projection),

Rede (discourse). Care (Sorge) as the structural whole.

Body B : Das Man – falling into anonymous publicness. Idle talk, curiosity, ambiguity.

Inauthenticity as Dasein's default.

Body C : Authenticity – call of conscience + being-toward-death → anticipatory resoluteness.

NOT a moral category – a formal modification of everydayness (owning one's thrown

projection). Authenticity does not take Dasein OUT of the world; it lets Dasein be

in-the-world in a way that is **owned**, not dispersed.

Crit : Formally empty (no content); Levinas – primacy of the Other, not death; political

danger of content-free authenticity (Heidegger's own complicity).

Close : Being-in-the-world is the **what**; authenticity is the **how** – how Dasein takes up

its always-already world-involvement.

8.5 — PYQ 2022 Q4(a) 20m: "Kierkegaard's subjectivity + three stages."

Frame : Kierkegaard's "truth is subjectivity" is his counter to Hegel's objective System.

Body A : Subjectivity ≠ relativism. It is about the MODE of appropriation – infinite

passionate inwardness, existential commitment, risk. The how > the what for

existential/religious truth.

Body B : Three stages – Aesthetic (pleasure, irony → despair); Ethical (universal duty,

commitment → guilt); Religious (faith, the absurd, standing before God → paradox).

The movement between them: the LEAP – not logical, not dialectical, but decisional.

Body C : Against Hegel: Hegel resolves everything into the System; Kierkegaard insists that

the existing individual (den Enkelte) cannot be replaced by a completed system-view.

Spirit = the individual's self-relation, not Absolute Spirit.

Assess : Powerful critique of impersonal systematic philosophy; but risks fideism (abandoning

rational accountability) and elitism (who can make the leap?).

Close : For Kierkegaard, the three stages trace a path of intensifying inwardness – from

dispersion (aesthetic) through duty (ethical) to the "absolute relation to the

Absolute" (religious). Subjectivity IS this intensification.

8.6 — PYQ 2021 Q4(b) 15m: "If I do not choose, I am still choosing."

Frame : Sartre's claim that freedom is inescapable – even non-choice is choice.

Body A : Radical freedom: the pour-soi cannot NOT choose (its being = freedom/nihilation).

Not choosing (deferring, conforming, "waiting") is itself a choice – a choice to

let circumstances or others decide, which is bad faith (pretending I am not free).

Body B : Responsibility follows because evasion and conformity take up a stance, but

passion, upbringing, coercion and circumstance remain factual constraints.

Body C : "In choosing myself I choose man" – universal dimension of choice.

Crit : Is the distinction between choosing-not-to-choose and genuinely being unable to

choose real? Structural oppression (poverty, coercion) seems to limit not

just

action but awareness of alternatives. Sartre's later Marxist turn partly concedes this.

Close : The statement dramatises the inescapability of freedom – we are "condemned to be free"

not as a punishment but as an ontological structure.

8.7 — PYQ 2019 Q3(a) 20m: "Is Dasein authentic existence? Temporality and Dasein."

Frame : Dasein is NOT defined as "authentic existence" – authenticity is one *modification*

of Dasein's being. Dasein is mostly inauthentic (das Man, falling), and this is not

a deficiency but a structural feature.

Body A : Dasein's being = Care (ahead-of-itself-already-in-alongside).

Authenticity =

owning this structure through anticipatory resoluteness (being-toward-death + call

of conscience).

Body B : Temporality – the *meaning* of Care. Three ecstases: future (projection), having-been

(thrownness), present (making-present). Future has primacy – anticipation of death

gathers Dasein into a whole and enables authentic historicity.

Body C : Primordial temporality vs vulgar time: the "now-series" is a derivative, levelled-down

form. Authentic temporality is ecstatic and finite (bounded by death).

Crit : Division III (Time and Being) never published – the project remains incomplete.

Sartre: temporality grounds freedom (not just formal ontology). Levinas: death

individualises excessively – what about the temporality of the Other?

Close : Dasein is not "authentic existence" but the entity whose being (Care) is temporal and

which CAN exist authentically – by owning its finitude.

8.8 — PYQ 2019 Q4(c) 15m: "Sartre on freedom and determinism."

Frame : Early Sartre rejects accounts that treat the for-itself as mechanically fixed by

causal, psychological or social determinants.

Body A : The pour-soi is constituted by nihilation/transcendence – it can always negate any given

situation, interpret it anew, project beyond it. A "motive" has force only insofar as

the pour-soi freely constitutes it as a motive.

Body B : "There are no excuses" rejects a fully thing-like self, but passion, trauma,

coercion and social circumstance remain facticity; freedom operates only in situation.

Body C : Limitation: Sartre acknowledges "situation" (facticity) – but insists freedom operates

within situation, not *despite* it. I cannot fly, but I am free to interpret my

inability and to project alternatives.

Crit : Psychologically implausible (mental illness, extreme coercion); socially blind

(structural oppression). Sartre's later Critique of Dialectical Reason integrates

material constraints (practico-inert, seriality) – a significant self-revision.

Close : For Sartre, the "problem" of freedom and determinism is a false problem: determinism

misunderstands the pour-soi by treating it as en-soi (a thing among causes).

9. INTER-THINKER DEBATES ⚠

Axis	Kierkegaard	Sartre	Heidegger
God	Central — faith in the absurd, the God-relation	Denied — atheism as <i>premise</i>	Bracketed — ontology, not theology
Core term for human being	Den Enkelte (the individual, the single one)	Pour-soi (for-itself, nihilating consciousness)	Dasein (being-there, the entity that questions Being)
Path/authenticity	Religious faith in pseudonymous/signed contexts	Bad-faith critique; positive authenticity remains underdeveloped in <i>Being and Nothingness</i>	Anticipatory resoluteness (being-toward-death), not a moral code
Freedom	Qualitative choice within finite God-relation	Radical but situated freedom of the for-itself	Thrown projection/possibility, not Sartrean voluntarism
Temporality	Existence as <i>repetition</i> and <i>moment</i> (<i>Øjeblikket</i>) — the eternal entering time	Pour-soi as ecstatic (past/present/future); freedom nihilates the past	Zeitlichkeit — three ecstases, future-primacy, finite
Chief enemy	Hegel's System, the crowd, objective Christianity	Determinism, bad faith, the serious spirit	Cartesian dualism, <i>das Man</i> , metaphysics of presence
Relation to Hegel	Existing individual versus completed system	Uses Hegelian themes of negation/otherness but rejects teleological totality	Reopens the Being-question against metaphysics; relation is not simple inheritance
Mood disclosing truth	Anxiety (<i>Angest</i>), despair	Anguish (<i>angoisse</i>), nausea (<i>la nausée</i>)	Anxiety (<i>Angst</i>) — discloses the nothing/throwness

D. DIRECTIVE DECODER ⚠ — what each command word obliges you to *do* here

Directive	What it demands	Structural obligation for this file	Fatal error
Comment / Elucidate the statement (2021 "if I do not choose, I am still choosing"; 2023 "consciousness is what it is not")	locate the sentence in its own thinker's system , then unpack the technical terms	Identify the work, the pair of terms it turns on (pour-soi/en-soi, facticity/transcendence), then two consequences, then a judgment.	Treating the sentence as a general maxim about life.
Discuss existence precedes essence	reconstruct Sartre's atheistic/no-blueprint argument and project/facticity consequence	No divine artisan → no predetermined human blueprint → persons take up projects in situations. Then note Heidegger's rejection.	Attributing the slogan to every existentialist.
Critically examine authenticity (2019, 2022)	assessment dominates, and the non-moral reading is the marked point	State that <i>Eigentlichkeit</i> is an existential modification, not a virtue; then <i>das Man</i> , call of conscience, being-toward-death; then the charge of formal emptiness.	Treating authenticity as "being true to yourself."
Discuss being-in-the-world (2022, 20m)	the hyphens are the doctrine — show that the compound resists decomposition	Refuse the subject/object split first, then <i>Zuhandenheit/Vorhandenheit</i> , the broken hammer, care (<i>Sorge</i>), and only then temporality.	Describing Dasein as "a human being in the world."
How does Kierkegaard oppose Hegel?	a structural opposition, not a list of complaints	The existing individual vs the system; either/or vs both/and; the leap vs mediation; indirect communication vs the lecture. Add "a logical system is possible; an existential system is impossible."	"Kierkegaard disliked abstraction."
Explain freedom and determinism in Sartre (2019)	explain meaning-conferral together with facticity	Motives do not operate as mechanical causes of a thing-like self; analyse situation, project and later social constraint.	Pretending coercion, trauma or material limits are unreal.
Bring out the difference between fear and dread/anxiety	compare object-directed fear with existential anxiety/anguish while preserving thinker differences	Kierkegaard: possibility; Heidegger: collapse of world-significance; Sartre: freedom.	Treating three vocabularies as one identical mood theory.
Assess / Do you agree?	a defended ruling in the first line	Rule on radical freedom, on whether authenticity has content, or on whether conflict is really the basic relation with others.	Neutral survey.

V. GRADED VERDICT BANK — executable closing positions

Sub-topic	10-mark verdict	15-mark verdict	20-mark verdict
Existence precedes essence	Sartre's atheistic argument denies a predetermined human blueprint; it does not erase biological/social facticity.	...It is Sartre's slogan, not existentialism's common creed; Heidegger repudiates the humanist inversion and Kierkegaard is theistic.	The doctrine foregrounds project/responsibility but leaves value-criteria and situated constraint underdeveloped.
Radical freedom	Freedom is the for-itself's non-coincidence with facticity, exercised only in situation.	...Motives acquire action-guiding significance within a project; they are not irrelevant causes or instantly dismissible feelings.	Coercion, trauma and material structures pressure early radicalism; later scarcity/seriality broaden Sartre without simply retracting freedom.
Bad faith	Bad faith evades the tension of facticity and transcendence rather than merely lying.	...Pre-reflective/non-thetic awareness is Sartre's proposed answer to the self-deception paradox.	The account is influential but normatively incomplete because positive authenticity remains thin and its examples require contextual criticism.
The Look / being-for-others	Shame discloses myself as object for another subject; it is not an empirical proof of all other minds.	...Sartre improves on inferential models but may generalise conflict from selective encounters.	Love, solidarity, de Beauvoir, Fanon and later Sartre pressure subject/object exclusivity; these are bounded criticisms, not replacements.
Anguish / fear	Fear has a determinate threat; existential anxiety/anguish discloses possibility, freedom or world-collapse depending on the thinker.	...Kierkegaard, Heidegger and Sartre use related but non-identical moods.	A mood can disclose a structure without becoming infallible cognition; naturalistic and clinical explanations remain compatible competitors.
Authenticity (Heidegger)	<i>Eigentlichkeit</i> is an existential modification, not a moral achievement; Dasein is inauthentic proximally and for the most part, and this is structural.	...Anticipatory resoluteness gives Dasein its ownmost, non-relational, certain and indefinite possibility, and thereby a whole — but it prescribes no content whatever.	The formality is deliberate and it is the doctrine's deepest problem. Adorno's charge of a "jargon of authenticity," and the political catastrophe of Heidegger's own 1933, both press the same question: a criterion that tells you to own your choices without telling you which to make can dignify any resolute commitment. The defence — that fundamental ontology is not ethics — is textually correct and philosophically unsatisfying.
Kierkegaard vs Hegel	No completed system substitutes for the temporal choice of the existing individual.	...Leap, either/or and indirect communication resist mediated systematic closure, but Hegel need not simply deny individuality.	Kierkegaard exposes first-person appropriation that system-view risks losing; he does not offer a rival comprehensive ontology.

Sub-topic	10-mark verdict	15-mark verdict	20-mark verdict
Indirect communication	Ethical-religious appropriation cannot be handed over as neutral information.	...Pseudonyms stage existence-possibilities; attribution must follow their voices.	Revocation makes the method deliberately self-limiting, though whether it clarifies or evades doctrine remains disputed.

T. TRANSLATION, QUOTATION & PROVENANCE DISCIPLINE

Three languages (Danish, German, French), three posthumous-edition problems, and one name-attribution rule.

 **Official wording:** the syllabus prints "Sarte." Preserve it only in a verbatim syllabus quotation; the philosopher is Jean-Paul **Sartre**.

Kierkegaard (Danish)

Item	Status	Practice
Pseudonyms	See §2B	 Cite the pseudonym: "Johannes de Silentio," "Climacus," "Vigilius Haufniensis," "Anti-Climacus." Kierkegaard printed a request to this effect in the "First and Last Declaration" appended to the <i>Postscript</i> (1846).
Editions	Hong & Hong , <i>Kierkegaard's Writings</i> (Princeton, 1978–2000) — the scholarly standard; Walter Lowrie (1940s) — the older translations still reprinted in India; Alastair Hannay (Penguin)	 Wording differs substantially. Angest is " dread " in Lowrie and " anxiety " in Hong; the book is <i>The Concept of Dread</i> (Lowrie) or <i>The Concept of Anxiety</i> (Hong). Name the translation or use the Danish once.
"Truth is subjectivity"	<i>Concluding Unscientific Postscript</i> (1846), by Climacus	 Safe; attribute to Climacus.
"Anxiety is the dizziness of freedom"	<i>The Concept of Anxiety</i> (1844), by Vigilius Haufniensis	 Lowrie: "dizziness of freedom"; renderings vary slightly. Safe as a rendering with the attribution.
"Leap of faith"	 Provenance: Kierkegaard writes of <i>the leap</i> (<i>Springet</i>) and of faith; the fused phrase " leap of faith " is the English tradition's , not a literal translation of a Kierkegaardian term.	Write "the leap — what the English tradition calls the leap of faith."
"Life must be lived forwards but understood backwards"	From the journals , not a published work	 Say "in his journals."
<i>The Point of View for My Work as an Author</i>	Written 1848 , published posthumously 1859	 A retrospective self-interpretation; do not cite it as contemporaneous evidence of intention.

Heidegger (German)

Item	Status	Practice
<i>Sein und Zeit</i>	1927; ⚠️ Division Two of Part One only — the projected Part Two was never written.	✅ Cite by § number (§26 <i>Mitsein</i> ; §§27, 35–38 <i>das Man</i> , <i>Gerede</i> , <i>Verfallen</i> ; §40 <i>Angst</i> ; §§46–53 being-toward-death; §§54–60 conscience; §65 temporality) — § numbers are edition- and translation-invariant. ⚠️ Never write "in <i>Being and Time</i> Heidegger completes his analysis of Being" — he does not; the book is unfinished.
Translations	Macquarrie & Robinson (1962) and Joan Stambaugh (1996, rev. Schmidt 2010)	⚠️ Key differences: <i>Dasein</i> untranslated in both; <i>Befindlichkeit</i> = "state-of-mind" (M&R) vs "attunement" (Stambaugh); <i>das Man</i> = "the 'they'" (M&R) vs "the they" / "the anyone." Name the translation for any quoted phrase.
Technical terms	<i>Dasein</i> ; ready-to-hand (<i>Zuhandenheit</i>); present-at-hand (<i>Vorhandenheit</i>); thrownness (<i>Geworfenheit</i>); care (<i>Sorge</i>); the "they" (<i>das Man</i>); authenticity (<i>Eigentlichkeit</i>); being-toward-death (<i>Sein-zum-Tode</i>)	Write the English explanation first; retain <i>Dasein</i> untranslated and add German where it prevents ambiguity.
"Nothing noths" (<i>Das Nichts nichtet</i>)	<i>Was ist Metaphysik?</i> (1929), Heidegger's Freiburg inaugural lecture	✅ Correct renderings: "Nothing noths" / "the nothing nothings." ❌ "Nothing noughts" is wrong and must not be used. See Logical-Positivism.md §T.
Repudiation of Sartre	<i>Brief über den Humanismus / Letter on Humanism</i> (1946 , published 1947)	✅ Essential for any "existentialism" answer: Heidegger explicitly denies that his thought is existentialism, and rejects the formula "existence precedes essence" as a metaphysical inversion that stays within metaphysics.

Sartre (French)

Item	Status	Practice
<i>L'Être et le Néant / Being and Nothingness</i>	1943 ; Eng. tr. Hazel Barnes (1956); newer Sarah Richmond (2018)	⚠️ Barnes's renderings are the ones most Indian guides reproduce; Richmond revises many. Name the translation, or keep the French term.
Technical terms	in-itself (<i>en-soi</i>), for-itself (<i>pour-soi</i>), being-for-others (<i>pour-autrui</i>), nihilation (<i>néantisation</i>), bad faith (<i>mauvaise foi</i>), facticity (<i>facticité</i>), the Look (<i>le regard</i>)	Write the English concept first and give French once where useful.

Item	Status	Practice
<i>L'existentialisme est un humanisme</i>	Lecture October 1945 , published 1946 ; Eng. <i>Existentialism Is a Humanism</i>	⚠ It is a popular lecture , and Sartre later regretted publishing it. Slogans ("condemned to be free," "existence precedes essence," "man is nothing else but what he makes of himself") come from here , not from <i>Being and Nothingness</i> . Say so — it is a precision mark.
"L'enfer, c'est les autres"	<i>Huis clos (No Exit)</i> , play, 1944	✅ Safe verbatim in French. ⚠ Add Sartre's own correction of the popular reading (§2A(7)).
<i>Critique de la raison dialectique</i>	1960	✅ Cite for the later concessions: scarcity, seriality, the practico-inert, the group-in-fusion.

✗ **Never write:** "the existentialists held that..." as though Kierkegaard, Heidegger and Sartre share a doctrine — Kierkegaard is a Christian, Heidegger denied he was an existentialist, and only Sartre accepted the label; that authenticity means being true to oneself; that *Being and Time* is a completed system; or that "leap of faith" is a phrase of Kierkegaard's.

10. LINK-OUTS

- Phenomenology-Husserl.md — the parent method; intentionality → being-in-the-world; Heidegger was Husserl's student (dedicated *Being and Time* to him).
- Hegel.md — Kierkegaard's target (the individual vs the System); Sartre inherits dialectical structure.
- Kant.md — Sartre's quasi-Kantian universalisability; Kant on freedom and determinism (Third Antinomy — Heidegger inherits).
- Rationalism.md — Descartes' cogito and res cogitans — what Heidegger destroys by positing being-in-the-world.
- ../_themes/Critiques-of-metaphysics.md — existentialism's critique of essentialist/systematic metaphysics.
- ../_themes/Self-and-liberation-across-schools.md — Dasein vs ātman vs anātman; existential "liberation" (authenticity) vs mokṣa.
- ../indian/Vedanta.md — Advaita's "self is Brahman" vs existentialism's "no fixed self/essence."
- ../paper-2/philosophy-of-religion/Reason-Revelation-Faith.md — Kierkegaard's leap of faith; religion-without-God angle for atheistic existentialism.
- ../paper-2/philosophy-of-religion/Soul-Immortality-Rebirth.md — being-toward-death vs immortality.
- ../PYQ-Western-Philosophy-2018-2025.md — full PYQ bank.
- ../PYQ-Western-Philosophy-2026.md — 2026 PYQ bank (Section A).
- ../00_Master-Framework.md — house style and depth rules.

SOURCES

- Sartre, Jean-Paul. *Being and Nothingness* (*L'Être et le Néant*, 1943) — pour-soi/en-soi, nihilation, bad faith, radical freedom.
- Sartre, Jean-Paul. *Existentialism is a Humanism* (*L'existentialisme est un humanisme*, 1946) — the public lecture: paper-knife, "condemned to be free," anguish/abandonment/despair.
- Sartre, Jean-Paul. *Critique of Dialectical Reason* (1960) — the Marxist turn, scarcity, seriality.
- Heidegger, Martin. *Being and Time* (*Sein und Zeit*, 1927) — Dasein, being-in-the-world, Care, temporality, authenticity, being-toward-death.
- Heidegger, Martin. "Letter on Humanism" (1947) — rejection of Sartre's existentialism as humanistic metaphysics.
- Kierkegaard, Søren. *Either/Or* (1843) — aesthetic vs ethical stages.
- Kierkegaard, Søren. *Fear and Trembling* (1843) — Abraham, teleological suspension of the ethical, knight of faith.
- Kierkegaard, Søren. *Concluding Unscientific Postscript* (1846) — truth is subjectivity, the existing individual vs the System.
- Masih, Y. *A Critical History of Western Philosophy* — chapters on Existentialism.
- Kenny, Anthony. *A New History of Western Philosophy*, Vol. 4 — Heidegger and Sartre sections.
- Copleston, Frederick. *A History of Philosophy*, Vols. 7 and 11 — Kierkegaard, Heidegger, Sartre.
- Warburton, Nigel. *Philosophy: The Classics* — accessible Sartre overview.
- Audi, Robert (ed.). *The Cambridge Dictionary of Philosophy* — existentialism, anxiety, bad faith, Heidegger, Kierkegaard and Sartre entries.

11. RAPID REVISION AND CLOSED-BOOK RECALL

RAPID REVISION 1 — Family, precursors and boundaries

- Rebuild the Faith / Freedom / Finitude map.
- State why Nietzsche and Camus are bounded comparisons.
- Explain why Heidegger rejects Sartrean humanism. **Practice link:** MCQs 1–6

RAPID REVISION 2 — Kierkegaard: individual, subjectivity and anti-system

- Define *den Enkelte*, the how/what distinction and indirect communication.
- Explain both "truth is subjectivity" and "subjectivity is untruth." **Practice link:** MCQs 7–12

RAPID REVISION 3 — Kierkegaard: stages, anxiety, despair and faith

- Reconstruct aesthetic → ethical → religious without treating it as chronology.
- Distinguish anxiety, despair, resignation, faith and the leap. **Practice link:** MCQs 13–20

RAPID REVISION 4 — Sartre: existence, essence and humanism

- Run the paper-knife argument.
- Separate Sartre's slogan from Heidegger's ontological claim. **Practice link:** MCQs 21–25

RAPID REVISION 5 — Sartre: ontology, nothingness and Husserl

- Contrast en-soi and pour-soi.
- Explain Pierre's absence, the non-egological field and the 2026 comparison. **Practice link:** MCQs 26–33

RAPID REVISION 6 — Sartre: freedom, facticity and responsibility

- Derive freedom from nihilation without confusing it with physical omnipotence.
- Connect motive, project, situation, non-choice and later material constraint. **Practice link:** MCQs 34–40

RAPID REVISION 7 — Sartre: bad faith and being-for-others

- Reconstruct waiter, date, keyhole, shame and conflict.
- Give a qualified account of authenticity and social relations. **Practice link:** MCQs 41–48

RAPID REVISION 8 — Heidegger: Dasein, world and Care

- Define ontological difference and Dasein.
- Move from equipment and breakdown to existentialia and Care. **Practice link:** MCQs 49–55

RAPID REVISION 9 — Heidegger: inauthenticity, death and authenticity

- Explain *das Man*, falling, anxiety, conscience and anticipatory resoluteness.
- Keep the account non-moral without ignoring its ethical problem. **Practice link:** MCQs 56–61

RAPID REVISION 10 — Heidegger: temporality and historicity

- Map future / having-been / present onto Care.
- Distinguish primordial temporality from the public now-series. **Practice link:** MCQs 62–66

RAPID REVISION 11 — Criticism and comparative transfer

- Compare mood, authenticity, constraint and value across the three projects.
- State one objection and one reply for each thinker. **Practice link:** MCQs 67–74

12. FINAL CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

- Existentialism is a family of distinct projects, not one creed.
- Kierkegaard: *den Enkelte*, subjective appropriation, qualitative spheres, anxiety, despair, faith and anti-system critique.
- Sartre: existence before essence, en-soi/pour-soi, nothingness, situated freedom, responsibility, bad faith and the Look.
- Heidegger: fundamental ontology, Dasein, being-in-the-world, equipment, Care, *das Man*, death, authenticity and temporality.
- Sartre's freedom is not arbitrary preference or physical omnipotence.
- Heideggerian authenticity is not moral goodness; its formal emptiness is the central criticism.

- Husserlian epoché and transcendental reduction remain Husserl's; Heidegger rejects the worldless starting point.
- Sartre retains Husserlian intentionality while rejecting an ego inside consciousness.
- Fear has a determinate object; existential anxiety has no determinate intrawordly object.
- Attribute texts and pseudonyms precisely; use "leap of faith" only with provenance caution.
- Treat Nietzsche, Camus, Jaspers, Marcel and de Beauvoir as bounded enrichment unless a question names them.
- Every conclusion should be graded: preserve the insight, state the limit, and avoid flattening the thinkers.